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Focused Observation of Practice (FoP): Curriculum & Subject Knowledge

Comments: these can be things that you notice and questions you would like to ask to find out more

Reflections: If you can, please discus your questions and comments with the teacher that you have observed

N.B. If being used by a student teacher to observe a lesson, we suggest you focus on only 2-3 of the areas listed below.

Teacher's Name/Subject..... Class/Set..... Date/Time.....

	COMMENTS/QUESTIONS
Subject Knowledge *The following questions help you consider how a teacher's confident subject knowledge supports their planning and teaching* • How does the teacher convey confident subject knowledge per se and/or links to degree content/interests/ expertise? • How does the teacher use subject knowledge to anticipate and respond to pupils' difficulties and misconceptions? • How does the teacher use subject knowledge to plan for pupils' subject progression within/across lessons? • How does the teacher incorporate appropriate subject-specific vocabulary within the lesson? What impact does this have on pupil learning? **Curriculum Knowledge** *The following questions help you consider how a teacher's confident knowledge of the National/school curriculum supports their planning and teaching.* • How has the teacher planned objectives related to relevant curriculum/ syllabus/external assessment? • How does the teacher's curriculum knowledge help them to plan for subject progression within/across lessons? • How does the teacher use their curriculum knowledge to anticipate and respond to difficulties and misconceptions? • How does the teacher use their curriculum knowledge to identify/teach/build on foundational content knowledge? How does this understanding of curriculum help them to plan and teach increasingly complex content? • How does the teacher draw on their curriculum knowledge to assess pupils' progress during/across lessons? **Knowledge of Learners/How Children Learn** • How does the teacher present themselves as a positive role model during the lesson? Does their passion for subject motivate and enthuse pupils? • How does the teacher choose/adapt content to ensure it is appropriate to the pupils' age and key stage? • How does the teacher adapt their teaching to support pupils with special educational needs/language requirements? • Are challenging tasks presented to all pupils? How is modelling and scaffolding used to make challenge accessible? • How are assessment for learning strategies implemented to support pupil progress over time? • How is homework used to support pupil learning? • What types of quality teaching and learning materials are used to motivate and support pupil learning? **Pedagogical Knowledge** • Have clear, precise lesson objectives been created to support pupil learning? • Has the teacher created and shared clear success criteria with pupils? If so, what impact does this have and why? • How has the teacher planned the lesson to ensure each section is logically linked and progressive? • How are subject-specific learning and teaching methods incorporated? • How is subject-specific research and thinking used to inform classroom practice?	

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REFLECTIONS AND NEXT STEPS

What was successful about how curriculum and subject knowledge was used within the lesson and why?

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How will you use this observation to help you with your planning and teaching?

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